

Known by God—More Than a Résumé of Deeds

Sunday Service Sermon

Text: Matthew 7:21–23; John 17:3; 1 Corinthians 8:3

1. Call to Worship & Opening Prayer

“Come, let us bow down in worship, let us kneel before the LORD our Maker” (Psalm 95).

Prayer: Father, gather our scattered thoughts and center us on Christ so we may hear Your heart and respond in faith. Amen.

2. Introduction

Good morning, church! Our culture rewards performance—grades, likes, and résumés. Yet Jesus warns that on Judgment Day some will hear the chilling words, “I never knew you.”

Tonight we ask: What makes the Lord say, “I know you”?

3. Religious Activity ≠ Relationship

- Parable of the Two Builders (Matthew 7:24–27)—Same-looking houses, different foundations. Storms reveal whether we merely admire Jesus’ words or build on them.
- Saul versus David—Saul’s flashy disobedience cost him the crown (1 Samuel 15). David’s repentant heart kept him in covenant (Acts 13:22).

4. Five Marks of a Life God Recognises

a) Enter through Christ Alone

- Thief on the Cross (Luke 23:39–43) brought no deeds, only faith.

b) Abide Daily

- Mary over Martha (Luke 10:38–42) shows relationship before task.

c) Walk in Continual Repentance

- David’s Psalm 51 cry: “Create in me a clean heart.”

d) Obey Promptly

- Ananias in Acts 9 risked his safety to pray for Saul—love in action.

e) Love Sacrificially

- Early believers sold possessions so “there were no needy persons among them” (Acts 4:34).

5. Contemporary Illustration

Imagine two employees. One masters every procedure but never meets the CEO. The other, though competent, intentionally spends time with the CEO—coffee chats, honest questions. When promotion day comes, whose name is called? Relationship trumps résumé.

6. Heart Check

- Word—Do I let Scripture read me daily?
- Prayer—Is it dialogue or monologue?
- Obedience—Do I act on His whispers promptly?
- Love—Do people around me feel Christ’s kindness?
- Fruit—Is the Spirit producing visible change?

7. Invitation & Altar Call

If you realise you have religion without relationship, come. Like Peter stepping onto the water, take one brave step toward Jesus:

1. Believe He died and rose for you.
2. Repent of self-reliance.
3. Receive Him as Lord and Friend.

Sample Prayer:

“Lord Jesus, I confess I have lived on my own terms. I believe You died for my sins and rose again. Forgive me, fill me with Your Spirit, and write Your name upon my heart. Amen.”

8. Closing Blessing

May the God who “knows those who are His” (2 Timothy 2:19) keep you in intimate fellowship until the day He gladly says, “Well done... I know you.” Amen.